

## INTRO

Hello, I'm \_\_\_\_, and I'm calling on behalf of Threshold 2008 in partnership with Stanford University's Center for Deliberative Democracy. We are not asking for donations. We are simply calling to ask about your views about housing issues in San Mateo County, including where future development, if any, should take place and the possibility of building affordable housing in San Mateo County. We want to give ordinary citizens a voice in the current discussion about these issues. Respondents need to be age 18 or older. In order to assure a representative sample for our survey could we speak to the adult in your household whose birthday is coming up next?

*Repeat INTRO if new person*

*If continuing with the same person*

This survey will take only a few minutes and all information is confidential.

Do you have a few minutes to answer our questions now?

Now we'd like you to think about some important housing issues in San Mateo County.

1. Some people think we should create more housing in the county. Suppose people who believe this are at one end of a scale, at point 1. Other people think we should restrict housing growth in the county. Suppose people who believe this are at the other end, at point 7. People who are exactly in the middle are at point 4, and of course other people are at points 2, 3, 5, or 6. Where would you place yourself on this scale, or haven't you thought much about this?

| Creating more housing |   |   | Exactly in the middle |   |   | Restricting housing growth | Haven't thought much about it |
|-----------------------|---|---|-----------------------|---|---|----------------------------|-------------------------------|
| 1                     | 2 | 3 | 4                     | 5 | 6 | 7                          | 99                            |

2. Some people think that any new housing should be located in already developed areas. Suppose people who believe this are at one end of a scale, at point 1. Other people think that any new housing should be located in currently protected open space areas rezoned to allow housing developments. Suppose people who believe this are at the other end, at point 7. People who are exactly in the middle are at point 4, and of course other people are at points 2, 3, 5, or 6. Where would you place yourself on this scale, or haven't you thought much about this?

| Already developed areas |   |   | Exactly in the middle |   |   | Open space areas rezoned to allow housing | Haven't thought much about it |
|-------------------------|---|---|-----------------------|---|---|-------------------------------------------|-------------------------------|
| 1                       | 2 | 3 | 4                     | 5 | 6 | 7                                         | 99                            |

3. If new housing is restricted, some people think we should still try to attract new jobs to the county, even if that increases the number of commuters. Suppose people who believe this are at one end of a scale, at point 1. Other people think we should try to minimize the number of commuters, even if that reduces job growth. Suppose people who believe this are at the other end, at point 7. People who are exactly in the middle are at point 4. Where would you place yourself on this scale, or haven't you thought much about this?

|                            |   |   |                       |   |   |                    |                               |
|----------------------------|---|---|-----------------------|---|---|--------------------|-------------------------------|
| Attract jobs to the county |   |   | Exactly in the middle |   |   | Restrict commuters | Haven't thought much about it |
| 1                          | 2 | 3 | 4                     | 5 | 6 | 7                  | 99                            |

4. Some people think developers should be required to provide a certain portion of their homes at prices below the market rate. Suppose people who believe this are at one end of a scale, at point 1. Other people think developers should be allowed to sell homes at whatever price the market will support. Suppose people who believe this are at the other end, at point 7. People who are exactly in the middle are at point 4. Where would you place yourself on this scale, or haven't you thought much about this?

|                                                           |   |   |                       |   |   |                                       |                               |
|-----------------------------------------------------------|---|---|-----------------------|---|---|---------------------------------------|-------------------------------|
| Require certain portion of homes at below the market rate |   |   | Exactly in the middle |   |   | Allow homes to be sold at market rate | Haven't thought much about it |
| 1                                                         | 2 | 3 | 4                     | 5 | 6 | 7                                     | 99                            |

5. Which of the following should have the **most** say in planning and approving new housing development?
1. Each town or city
  2. A countywide authority
  3. The state government of California
  99. Or haven't you thought much about this
6. And which should have the **least** say in planning and approving new housing development?
1. Each town or city
  2. A countywide authority
  3. The state government of California
  99. Or haven't you thought much about this
7. On a scale of 0 to 10, where 0 is completely unimportant, 10 is extremely important, and 5 is exactly in the middle, how important would you say it is to increase public consultation in the planning and approval of new housing development?

| Completely unimportant |   |   |   |   | Exactly in the middle |   |   |   |   | Extremely important |  | Haven't thought much about it |
|------------------------|---|---|---|---|-----------------------|---|---|---|---|---------------------|--|-------------------------------|
| 0                      | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 | 5                     | 6 | 7 | 8 | 9 | 10                  |  | 99                            |

8. Some people think local communities should retain control over land use. Suppose people who believe this are at one end of a scale, at point 1. Other people think land use policies should be coordinated countywide. Suppose people who believe this are at the other end, at point 7. People

who are exactly in the middle are at point 4. Where would you place yourself on this scale, or haven't you thought much about this?

| Local control of land use |   |   | Exactly in the middle |   |   | Regional coordination within the county | Haven't thought much about it |
|---------------------------|---|---|-----------------------|---|---|-----------------------------------------|-------------------------------|
| 1                         | 2 | 3 | 4                     | 5 | 6 | 7                                       | 99                            |

9. Some people think housing is a county-level issue. Suppose people who believe this are at one end of a scale, at point 1. Other people think housing is a broader, state-level issue. Suppose people who believe this are at the other end, at point 7. People who are exactly in the middle are at point 4. Where would you place yourself on this scale, or haven't you thought much about this?

| County-level issue |   |   | Exactly in the middle |   |   | State-level issue | Haven't thought much about it |
|--------------------|---|---|-----------------------|---|---|-------------------|-------------------------------|
| 1                  | 2 | 3 | 4                     | 5 | 6 | 7                 | 99                            |

10. How strongly would you support or oppose more regional authority over housing policy? Would you ...

1. Strongly support it
2. Somewhat support it
3. Neither support nor oppose it
4. Somewhat oppose it
5. Strongly oppose it
99. Or haven't you thought much about this

11. Who should be **most** responsible for ensuring regional cooperation?

1. Existing Bay Area regional agencies
2. County government
3. Local governments collaborating voluntarily
4. A new countywide authority for housing issues
99. Or haven't you thought much about this

12. The next few questions ask you to consider the consequences of new housing development in the county.

12a. Would encouraging new housing development greatly increase, somewhat increase, neither increase nor decrease, somewhat decrease or greatly decrease **the quality of life**?

12b. Would encouraging new housing development greatly increase, somewhat increase, neither increase nor decrease, somewhat decrease or greatly decrease **economic vitality**?

12c. Would encouraging new housing development greatly increase, somewhat increase, neither increase nor decrease, somewhat decrease or greatly decrease **social and family connections**?

12d. Would encouraging new housing development greatly increase, somewhat increase, neither increase nor decrease, somewhat decrease or greatly decrease **property values**?

12e. Would encouraging new housing development greatly increase, somewhat increase, neither increase nor decrease, somewhat decrease or greatly decrease **civic participation**?

12f. Would encouraging new housing development greatly increase, somewhat increase, neither increase nor decrease, somewhat decrease or greatly decrease **quality of schools**?

12g. Would encouraging new housing development greatly increase, somewhat increase, neither increase nor decrease, somewhat decrease or greatly decrease **decrease city and county tax revenues**?

12h. Would encouraging new housing development greatly increase, somewhat increase, neither increase nor decrease, somewhat decrease or greatly decrease **infrastructure costs**?

13. As far as the city and county governments are concerned, would new housing development in the county create...

1. a large budget surplus
2. a small budget surplus
3. neither a budget deficit nor a budget surplus
4. a small budget deficit
5. a large budget deficit
99. Or haven't you thought much about this

14. Now suppose any new housing development were concentrated in already developed areas. On a scale from 0 to 10, where 0 is extremely bad, 10 is extremely good, and 5 is exactly in the middle, how good or bad would new housing development be for the environment? Or haven't you thought much about this?

15. And on another 0-to-10 scale, where 0 is not at all, 10 is a very great deal, and 5 is exactly in the middle, how much do you think restricting new housing development would cause companies in the county to move away? Or haven't you thought much about this?

16. And again on the same 0-to-10 scale, where 0 is not at all, 10 is a very great deal, and 5 is exactly in the middle, how much would you say the County's vital services like education, fire, police, and health care would suffer if there continues to be a shortage of affordable housing? Or haven't you thought much about this?

17. And how much would you agree or disagree with each of the following statements?

|                                                                                                                                                         | Agree<br>strongly | Agree<br>somewhat | Neither agree<br>nor disagree | Disagree<br>somewhat | Disagree<br>strongly | Haven't<br>thought<br>much<br>about it |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------|-------------------|-------------------------------|----------------------|----------------------|----------------------------------------|
| A. Local review of housing projects is the only way communities can hold developers accountable                                                         | 1                 | 2                 | 3                             | 4                    | 5                    | 99                                     |
|                                                                                                                                                         |                   |                   |                               |                      |                      |                                        |
| B. Local government is too responsive to the most vocal residents                                                                                       | 1                 | 2                 | 3                             | 4                    | 5                    | 99                                     |
|                                                                                                                                                         |                   |                   |                               |                      |                      |                                        |
| C. Countywide approaches create new options unavailable to any individual city                                                                          | 1                 | 2                 | 3                             | 4                    | 5                    | 99                                     |
|                                                                                                                                                         |                   |                   |                               |                      |                      |                                        |
| D. Countywide approaches allow for sharing resources across cities                                                                                      | 1                 | 2                 | 3                             | 4                    | 5                    | 99                                     |
|                                                                                                                                                         |                   |                   |                               |                      |                      |                                        |
| E1. San Mateo County can have job growth without housing growth                                                                                         | 1                 | 2                 | 3                             | 4                    | 5                    | 99                                     |
| E2. San Mateo County cannot accommodate job growth without housing growth.                                                                              |                   |                   |                               |                      |                      |                                        |
|                                                                                                                                                         |                   |                   |                               |                      |                      |                                        |
| F. Requiring developers to include housing priced at below the market rate will make them build less housing                                            | 1                 | 2                 | 3                             | 4                    | 5                    | 99                                     |
|                                                                                                                                                         |                   |                   |                               |                      |                      |                                        |
| G. Rezoning some currently protected open space areas to allow housing development now will lead to still more similar rezoning and developments later. | 1                 | 2                 | 3                             | 4                    | 5                    | 99                                     |
|                                                                                                                                                         |                   |                   |                               |                      |                      |                                        |
| H1. Public funding for housing developments will bring the price down to what most people can afford                                                    | 1                 | 2                 | 3                             | 4                    | 5                    | 99                                     |
| H2. Public funding for housing developments will not be enough to bring the price down to what most people can afford                                   |                   |                   |                               |                      |                      |                                        |
|                                                                                                                                                         |                   |                   |                               |                      |                      |                                        |
| I1. Public funding for housing developments can be allocated fairly                                                                                     | 1                 | 2                 | 3                             | 4                    | 5                    | 99                                     |
| I2. It is impossible to allocate public funding for housing developments fairly                                                                         |                   |                   |                               |                      |                      |                                        |

18. Here are some things that people find more or less important. On a scale of 0 to 10, where 0 is completely unimportant, 10 is extremely important, and 5 is exactly in the middle, how important would you say each of the following is to you?

|                                                                   | Completely<br>unimportant |   |   |   |   | Exactly in<br>the middle |   |   |   |   | Extremely<br>important | Haven't<br>thought<br>much about<br>it |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------|---|---|---|---|--------------------------|---|---|---|---|------------------------|----------------------------------------|
| a. Making sure that everyone<br>has a place to live               | 0                         | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 | 5                        | 6 | 7 | 8 | 9 | 10                     | 99                                     |
| b. Preserving open space                                          | 0                         | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 | 5                        | 6 | 7 | 8 | 9 | 10                     | 99                                     |
| c. Encouraging economic<br>growth                                 | 0                         | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 | 5                        | 6 | 7 | 8 | 9 | 10                     | 99                                     |
| d. Maintaining the current<br>character of our communities        | 0                         | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 | 5                        | 6 | 7 | 8 | 9 | 10                     | 99                                     |
| e. Having middle-income<br>workers in the community               | 0                         | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 | 5                        | 6 | 7 | 8 | 9 | 10                     | 99                                     |
| f. Making it possible for people<br>who grew up here to live here | 0                         | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 | 5                        | 6 | 7 | 8 | 9 | 10                     | 99                                     |
| h. Slowing the growth of<br>suburban sprawl                       | 0                         | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 | 5                        | 6 | 7 | 8 | 9 | 10                     | 99                                     |
| i. Having lower income workers<br>in the community                | 0                         | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 | 5                        | 6 | 7 | 8 | 9 | 10                     | 99                                     |

Now we come to some questions to which not everyone may know the answer. If we come to one to which you don't know the answer, don't worry about it—just say so, and we'll move on to the next one.

19. According to the Association of Bay Area Governments, between 1999 and 2006, what was the gap each year between the number of new homes needed and the number actually produced in San Mateo County?

1. about 200
2. about 500
3. about 1,000
4. about 5,000
5. about 8,000
99. Or couldn't you say about that?

20. As of September 2007, about how much was the median price of a single-family home in San Mateo County?

1. \$550,000
2. \$680,000
3. \$750,000
4. \$830,000
5. \$940,000

99. Or couldn't you say about that?

21. As of 2006, about what percentage of County households could afford a median-priced house in San Mateo County?

1. 12%
2. 23%
3. 37%
4. 43%
5. 55%

99. Or couldn't you say about that?

22. As of September 2007, what was the average rent for a 2-bedroom apartment in San Mateo County?

1. \$1,100
2. \$1,300
3. \$1,700
4. \$2,200
5. \$3,000

99. Or couldn't you say about that?

23. According to the 2006 San Mateo County Housing Needs Study, by about how many housing units is the demand for housing in San Mateo County projected to grow between 2005 and 2025?

1. 20,000
2. 40,000
3. 60,000
4. 70,000
5. 90,000

99. Or couldn't you say about that?

24. According to the same Housing Needs Study, among the new households that are expected to form in the County between 2005 and 2025, about what percentage, combined, would be households with low, very low and extremely low-incomes?

1. less than one-third
2. less than one-half
3. about half
4. more than one-half
5. more than two-thirds

99. Or couldn't you say about that?

25. According to the 2006 San Mateo County Housing Needs Study, roughly how many new homes (including houses, townhomes, condos and apartments) will be built between 2005 and 2025 at the current rate of housing development?

1. 25,000
2. 50,000
3. 75,000
4. 100,000

99. Or couldn't you say about that?

26. What percentage of San Mateo County's land is agricultural use, watershed, open space, wetlands, or parks?

1. less than 25%
2. 33%
3. 58%
4. 67%
5. more than 75%
99. Or couldn't you say about that?

27. How many times have you attended a city council meeting or planning commission meeting at which a proposed housing development was being considered? If you've never attended one, just say "zero."

\_\_\_\_\_

28. Which of the following best describes the highest level of education you have completed?

- 01 Less than high school
- 02 High school
- 03 Some university / college
- 04 University / college graduate
- 05 Some graduate work
- 06 Graduate degree
- 07 Other (specify: \_\_\_\_\_ )
- 97 Refused/No answer

29. In what year were you born? \_\_\_\_\_

30A. And what is your current employment status? Are you currently ... :

- 1 Employed full-time
- 2 Employed part-time
- 3 Not employed, but actively looking for work; or
- 4 Student
- 5 Not actively looking for work
- 6 Refused

30B. (If employed in above) Which of the following best describes your employment?

- Self employed
- Business under 25 employees
- Business with 25 or more employees
- Government
- Other

31. Which of the following categories best fits your household's yearly income?

- Less than 23,000
- 23,001 to 40,000
- 40,001 to 55,000
- 55,001 to 75,000

75,001 to 95,000  
 95,001 to 125,000  
 More than 125,000  
 Refused

32. What ethnicity would best describe you?

White (Non-Hispanic/Latino)  
 Black/African American  
 Hispanic/Latino(a)  
 American Indian/Alaskan Native  
 Asian  
 Native Hawaiian/Pacific Islander  
 Other

33. How many people are in your household, *including you*? \_\_\_\_\_

34. How many children under 18 are currently living at your home? \_\_\_\_\_

35. Gender

1 Male  
 2 Female

36. Besides funerals and weddings, would you say you attend religious services...

- ☐ Every week
- ☐ Almost every week
- ☐ Once or twice a month
- ☐ A few times a year
- ☐ Never

### **37. Invitation Prompt Here**

That was the last question. Now I have a very special invitation. An organization call Threshold 2008 is working with Stanford University's Center for Deliberative Democracy to sponsor an unusual and important 2-day event for a randomly selected group of citizens from San Mateo County. On Saturday and Sunday, March 15 and 16th, you will have a chance to discuss issues about housing, including where future development if any should take place and the possibility of building affordable housing in San Mateo County with your fellow citizens and to question experts.

You will be paid \$200 for your time, and breakfast and lunch will be provided. The event is entirely non-partisan, and a wide range of views will be expressed and considered. The event will be filmed and covered extensively by the press. You will need to arrive by 8:30am Saturday and will be free to leave by 5pm although there is an optional reception from 5:00 to 7 pm. On Sunday you will need to arrive by 9 am and free to leave by 5:30pm.

The event will take place at Cañada College in Redwood City, and we are working with local agencies to provide supplemental shuttles to and from the college, as well as child care. We will confirm with you before the event whether these options will be available and, if so, how to access them.

At the end of the day, the views of the group as a whole will be documented and shared with the public and with policymakers.

- 1 Continue reading on next screen
- 2 Respondent declines while you are reading this text

If respondent declines then thank them for their time and end survey

Q:INVITE2

At this dialogue you'll be discussing issues that will affect all of us in the years to come. It doesn't matter whether or not you know a lot about these issues beforehand. We will provide some background information but the most important thing is that we are interested in knowing what you think. Past participants in dialogues of this kind have found it enjoyable and interesting. We hope that you will be able to take part in this exciting and important event. You have a chance to make your voice heard in the discussions about San Mateo County's future.

Would you be interested in attending?

- 1 Yes
- 2 No
- 3 Maybe

I:

IF (INVITE = 2) SKP DECLINE

IF (INVITE = 3) SKP MAYINF

SKP YESES

Q:DECLINE

Could you help us learn how to make future events more attractive by telling us why you feel this would not be of interest to you?

- 1 Too Old
- 2 Too Sick
- 3 Other Plans
- 4 Legitimacy
- 5 No Clue
- 6 Not Interested
- 7 Too Busy
- 8 Childcare
- 9 Transportation
- 10 Other [Specify]

I:

OTH 10 15 20 15 70

NUM 1 10 2 0

CLR 3 25

SHOW "Thank you for your time and thoughts on these issues, goodbye." 10 5 75 31

KEY

DISPOS = 18  
 SVYEND = SYSTIME  
 COMPLETE  
 CTRLEND

Q:YESES

That's great! We're delighted you can make it. Here is what will happen next...

We will be in touch with you in about 10 days -- first by mail and then by phone to give you more details about the event and to answer any questions you may have. They will be in regular contact with you until the day of the event.

Q:MAYINF

We understand not everyone can decide right away. We also realize that you may want some more information about the event and would be happy to send you some. Would you like us to send you additional information?

- 1 Yes
- 2 No

Q:MAYFLWD

When do you think you'll know whether or not you can come?

Date:

Q:FULLNAME

Could I get your name so that we can follow up with you about this meeting?

Name:

Q:STREET

Can I have your street address?

Q:CITY

And your city?

Name:

Street address:

City:

Q:STATE

T:6

And your state?

Name:

Street address:

City:

State:

Q:ZCODE

T:6

And your zip code?

Name:

Street address:

City:

State:  
Zip code:

Q:ALTPHN

T:3

Is there an alternate phone number where you can be contacted?

Phone:

Q:BSTTIM

What would be the best time for someone to contact you by phone?

Record day/time:

Q:COMMENT1

T:3

Enter any respondent issues or questions below

Q:END

T:3

We really hope you will be able to take part in this exciting and important event. You have a chance to influence the way your community -- and the country as a whole -- thinks about issues that affect all of us.